READING PART 1

*Read the text. Fill in each gap with **ONE** word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text*

BABIES' MEMORIES

Most people cannot recall memories of being a baby, nor of their infancy. However, some **1.** _____ claim they can remember things that happened in the first year of their lives. Researchers at Yale and Columbia University in the United States studied why people have no recollection of things that happened in the first four or five years of their **2.** _____. The research team also investigated whether or not babies formed memories at all. Researcher Dr Tristan Yates suggested we may not be able to remember being a baby. He said: "Our results suggest that babies' brains have the capacity for forming **3.** _____, but how long-lasting these memories are is still an open question."

The research has been published in the journal "Science". It suggests that babies as young as a year old can form and store memories. Researchers used a specially designed scanner to observe activity in an area of babies' **4.** _____ called the hippocampus. This is where memories are created and stored. The research found that **5.** _____ can form limited types of memories from the age of two months. It is possible that infants can detect patterns in people's faces, language, and in daily routines. However, episodic memory, which allows us to recall specific events, may take longer to form. The researchers say this kind of may not occur until the **6.** _____ has more fully matured.

Teacher Jamshid

READING PART 2

*Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used **ONCE** only. There are **TWO** extra statements which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.*

A. A course where children learn how to respond in case of injuries or emergencies.
B. A program that allows children to become familiar with different musical styles and instruments.
C. A course for children who want to grow fruits and vegetables in a greenhouse.
D. A class where students learn to care for and understand their household pets.
E. A course that helps children stay physically active through structured games.
F. A session that teaches young participants how to bake sweet treats.
G. A club where students use creative skills to express their ideas through drawing and painting.
H. A class that promotes leadership and collaboration by working together on tasks.
I. A program designed to help children become confident in public speaking.
J. A course for children who care about nature and want to plant trees.

7. *Tree Planting Course.* If your child enjoys being outdoors and has a passion for the environment, this course is the perfect fit. It introduces participants to the process of planting and caring for trees and flowers. Children will learn about different soil types, how to water plants properly, and the long-term benefits of greenery. The course also includes group gardening activities and eco-projects that inspire responsibility for nature.

8. *Power & Fitness Club.* This club is designed to keep children active and full of energy. Through a mix of fun sports, stretching exercises, and basic fitness routines, the program helps develop strength, flexibility, and a healthy lifestyle. Kids are encouraged to set personal fitness goals and work towards them in a supportive and engaging environment. It's a great way to build confidence and healthy habits from an early age.

9. *SOS Skills.* Knowing how to react in an emergency can be a lifesaver, and this course provides just that knowledge. Children will be taught how to deal with common accidents, call for help, and offer first aid when necessary. Activities include role-playing scenarios such as helping someone who has fallen or calling emergency services. The aim is to build awareness, kindness, and a sense of responsibility in young participants.

Teacher Jamshid

10. *Creative Skills.* This program helps children explore their artistic side in a supportive and imaginative space. Whether it's painting colorful landscapes or learning to draw cartoons, participants are encouraged to express themselves through various art forms. They will also experiment with colors, textures, and styles while learning basic techniques used by real artists. The final day includes an art exhibition where children can display their work to friends and family.

11. *Melodic Tools, Tune.* If your child loves music, this course offers the chance to discover a range of musical instruments such as drums, guitars, keyboards, and flutes. Students will learn the basics of reading music, keeping rhythm, and playing simple tunes. They will also get to perform in small groups, allowing them to build confidence while having fun. No previous musical experience is necessary.

12. *Domestic Animal Care.* Caring for animals teaches responsibility and empathy. In this course, children will learn how to look after common household pets, including feeding routines, hygiene, and behavior signs. They'll also discuss the importance of love, patience, and the commitment needed to raise animals properly. Fun workshops and interactive games help reinforce these lessons while encouraging children to become thoughtful pet owners.

13. *Team Challenge.* This activity is all about solving problems together. In small teams, children will face a variety of mental and physical challenges, from building simple structures using limited materials to completing obstacle courses. These tasks help improve communication, cooperation, and leadership skills. It's not about winning—it's about learning to support others and work toward a common goal.

14. *Baking & Pastry Club.* Budding young chefs will enjoy this hands-on cooking experience. This course teaches children how to prepare delicious baked goods, including cookies, cupcakes, and pastries. Step-by-step guidance is provided, with a focus on safety and hygiene in the kitchen. Participants also learn how to measure ingredients, follow recipes, and decorate their creations creatively. At the end, everyone gets to take home their treats and a printed recipe book.

Teacher Jamshid

READING PART 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

A) Developing discipline and long-term commitment	**E)** Academic benefits of music training
B) Cultural exposure through music	**F)** Unlocking creativity and innovation
C) The role of music in emotional healing	**G)** Music and physical strength
D) Music as a path to financial success	**H)** Building teamwork and social skills

15. The process of learning to play a musical instrument involves complex cognitive functions. Young musicians are required to read sheet music, decode musical notations, and synchronize their motor skills to produce coherent sounds. These activities stimulate brain areas associated with memory, attention, and problem-solving. Research suggests that musical instrument training enhances cognitive abilities, leading to improved academic performance in areas such as mathematics, language, and spatial reasoning.

16. Playing a musical instrument provides a unique avenue for emotional expression and personal growth. Young people often find solace and catharsis through music, allowing them to channel their emotions effectively. The act of playing an instrument can alleviate stress, anxiety, and depression by engaging the mind and body in a fulfilling and creative activity. Moreover, musical self-expression fosters self-confidence, self-esteem, and a positive self-image, contributing to overall psychological well-being.

17. Engaging with musical instruments offers ample opportunities for social interaction and collaboration. Participating in ensembles, orchestras, or bands allows young musicians to work in teams, fostering valuable interpersonal skills. They learn to listen attentively, communicate effectively, and coordinate their efforts to create a harmonious musical performance. Collaborative musical experiences not only build social connections but also cultivate empathy, tolerance, and mutual respect among young individuals.

18. Learning to play a musical instrument demands discipline, perseverance, and time management skills. Regular practice schedules, setting goals, and striving for improvement instill a strong work ethic in young musicians. The commitment required to master an instrument teaches them the importance of consistent effort, patience, and overcoming challenges. These attributes transfer beyond the realm of music and positively impact their academic pursuits and personal endeavors.

19. Playing a musical instrument nurtures creativity and fosters critical thinking skills. Through improvisation, composition, and interpretation of musical pieces, young musicians are encouraged to explore their own artistic voice and think outside the box. Musical training promotes problem-solving abilities, as musicians often encounter complex passages that require innovative approaches.

Teacher Jamshid

20. Furthermore, the study of musical instruments can also foster cultural appreciation and global awareness in young individuals. Through exposure to different musical styles and traditions, young musicians gain a broader understanding of diverse cultures and develop a sense of cultural empathy. They learn to appreciate and respect various musical genres, instruments, and techniques from around the world, expanding their horizons beyond their immediate surroundings. - generate multilevel reading part 3 - Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Teacher Jamshid

READING PART 4

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

THE BENEFITS OF MINDFULNESS MEDITATION ON MENTAL HEALTH

Mindfulness meditation is a practice that has been gaining popularity in recent years due to its many mental and physical health benefits. This traditional Buddhist practice has been passed down from generation to generation since ancient times, and it involves focusing on the present moment and accepting one's thoughts and feelings without judgment. In recent years, researchers have conducted numerous studies to investigate the effects of mindfulness meditation on mental health, and the results have been overwhelmingly positive.

Studies have shown that mindfulness meditation can help to reduce symptoms of depression, anxiety, and stress, as well as improve overall psychological well-being. One study found that mindfulness meditation led to a 38% reduction in symptoms of depression and anxiety, which is significant, given the high prevalence of these conditions in the general population. Another study found that individuals who practiced mindfulness meditation for just 10 minutes a day experienced significant reductions in stress levels, as well as improvements in self-esteem and life satisfaction.

One of the reasons why mindfulness meditation is so effective is because it teaches individuals to increase their awareness of their thoughts and feelings, and to accept them without judgment. In other words, mindfulness meditation helps us to become more mindful of our own mental and emotional states, which can be incredibly beneficial in terms of mental health. By developing this awareness, individuals can learn to recognize negative thought patterns and replace them with more positive, constructive thoughts, which can help to improve mood and reduce symptoms of anxiety, depression, and stress.

Another benefit of mindfulness meditation is that it can help to enhance our sense of well-being and overall quality of life. By focusing on the present moment and learning to let go of negative thoughts and emotions, individuals can experience a greater sense of peace and contentment in their daily lives. This can lead to improved relationships, better sleep, and a greater sense of purpose and meaning in life.

In addition to these mental health benefits, mindfulness meditation has also been shown to have physical health benefits as well. Studies have found that regular practice of mindfulness meditation can help to lower blood pressure, reduce chronic pain, and improve overall immune system function. This is likely due to the fact that mindfulness meditation helps to reduce stress levels, which can have a negative impact on many aspects of physical health.

Overall, the benefits of mindfulness meditation on mental health are clear. This ancient practice can help to reduce symptoms of depression, anxiety, and stress, while also improving overall psychological well-being and quality of life. Mindfulness meditation is a simple, accessible, and effective way to improve mental health, and it is a practice that everyone can benefit from, regardless of their age or background. So, whether you are

Teacher Jamshid

looking to reduce symptoms of anxiety and depression or simply want to enhance your overall sense of well-being, mindfulness meditation is a powerful tool that can help you achieve these goals.

For questions 21-24, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

21. What is the primary focus of mindfulness meditation?

A) Remembering positive past events

B) Planning future goals and ambitions

C) Concentrating on the present moment

D) Controlling all emotional reactions

22. According to the text, why is mindfulness meditation considered helpful for mental health?

A) It provides immediate medical treatment for mental illness.

B) It helps individuals avoid all negative thoughts.

C) It increases awareness and acceptance of one's thoughts and feelings.

D) It teaches people to stop thinking completely.

23. What was the result of practicing mindfulness meditation for just 10 minutes a day?

A) It completely cured depression and anxiety.

B) It resulted in greater sleep duration.

C) It showed significant drops in stress and improved self-esteem.

D) It had no measurable impact on participants' mood.

24. How does mindfulness meditation benefit physical health?

A) By increasing the body's need for medication

B) Through reducing stress, which affects physical systems

C) By making people exercise more regularly

D) By curing chronic illnesses instantly

For questions 25-29, decide if the following statements agree with the information given in the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

25. Mindfulness meditation is a recently invented technique.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

26. Some studies showed a 38% decline in anxiety and depression symptoms.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

27. People with severe mental health conditions should not practice mindfulness meditation.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

28. Mindfulness can help individuals replace negative thoughts with more constructive ones.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

29. Mindfulness meditation is beneficial for people of all ages and backgrounds.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

Teacher Jamshid

READING PART 5

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

FISHING

Scientists compared catch data from four years before and after a moratorium and found minimal impact on commercial fishing. Banning fishing in a Mexican marine park did not reduce the fishing catch, according to a new study that says it has dispelled the "myth" spread by fishing companies that protecting marine areas leaves less fish available for people consumption.

The before-and-after study looked at whether banning commercial fishing from the Revillagigedo national park, which covers 147,000 sq km of the Pacific Ocean west of Mexico, would reduce the country's catch volumes. The answer was no, said the study's authors, who said the finding showed that "large, fully protected MPAs (marine protected areas) can contribute to a more sustainable and equitable use of the ocean, without major economic repercussions on the fishing industry".

Befor fishing in the MPA was banned in 2017, Mexico's $1bn fishing sector had warned it could reduce their catch of tuna and other pelagic fish by 20%. But catch data comparisons from the four years before and after the ban showed the MPA "had no causal effect on catches or area use, and therefore did not cause harm to the Mexican fishing fleet", said Fabio Favoretto, a postdoctoral scholar at Scripps Institution of Oceanography in San Diego, California, and the lead author of the peer-reviewed study, published in the journal Science Advances.

One reason for the MPA's apparently minimal impact on commercial fishing, he said, might be that the protected area "was almost insignificant" compared with the expanse of the ocean available to the Mexican fleet. Another "highly speculative" conclusion might be the existence of more fish in the areas around, as well as inside, MPAs, caused by a "spillover effect" into the surrounding seas, he said, adding that the research team aimed to look at this issue in its next study.

Favoretto opined that it was unbearable for considerable amounts of fishing to have gone on there unnoticed, with boats potentially killing their transponder signals before entering the park. "Because we were able to see the fishing activity elsewhere, so we didn't have gaps in the activity data, we saw them somewhere else," he said.

By law Mexico's fishing fleet is required to carry vessel monitoring system (VMS) transponders, which must be left on and are physically difficult to turn off, Favoretto said. "You can switch off AIS (another boat tracking system), but you cannot switch off VMS, and our data is from the VMS." He said that neither had there been any significant displacement of fishing activity to other areas. "We looked at the displacement effect, but there was not more of that," he said, adding that ships were not going out further than before, with the fleets apparently catching the same volume of fish in a reduced area.

Teacher Jamshid

Illegal fishing during the four years was minimal as well, the researchers found, with average fishing activity within the MPA declining by 82%. Infractions were higher just after the ban, Favoretto said and dropped to zero once a specialised marine crime monitoring programme called Skylight was fully implemented in 2021. "I was surprised there was not more illegal fishing ... and this is another message from the study," he said, adding that compliance was unexpectedly high.

*For questions 30-33, fill in the missing information in the numbered spaces. Write no more than **ONE WORD** and / or **A NUMBER** for each question.*

30. The Revillagigedo marine park occupies a total area of _____ square kilometres in the Pacific Ocean.

31. Experts concluded that marine reserves can help manage the ocean in a _____ and fair manner.

32. Favoretto and his team found no significant change in the _____ of commercial fishing after the ban.

33. After the introduction of the monitoring programme called _____, illegal fishing activities dropped to zero.

For questions 34-35, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

34. What was the primary finding of the study regarding Mexico's marine park?

A) It led to an increase in tuna and pelagic fish catches.

B) It caused fishing fleets to move to new areas.

C) It had little to no negative impact on fishing output.

D) It significantly decreased the number of commercial fishing boats.

35. Why did the researchers plan to investigate the *"spillover effect"* in future studies?

A) To understand how fish may migrate into the protected zone.

B) To evaluate whether fish populations increased in adjacent areas.

C) To measure changes in tuna migration patterns.

D) To check if illegal fishing increased outside the park.

Teacher Jamshid